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Elevated rack device

Abstract

An elevated rack device for preparing food includes a base to which a plurality of uprights is attached. Each upright extends substantially perpendicularly from the base proximate to a first end of the base. A rack is attached to the plurality of uprights distal from the base and extends substantially colinearly with the base toward a second end of the base. A food item can be positioned on a top of the rack with surfaces of the food item being substantially accessible to a user and the food item being slidable from the rack.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(2) Not Applicable

THE NAMES OF THE PARTIES TO A JOINT RESEARCH AGREEMENT

(3) Not Applicable

INCORPORATION-BY-REFERENCE OF MATERIAL SUBMITTED ON A COMPACT DISC OR AS A TEXT FILE VIA THE OFFICE ELECTRONIC FILING SYSTEM

(4) Not Applicable

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR DISCLOSURES BY THE INVENTOR OR JOINT INVENTOR

(5) Not Applicable

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) Field of the Invention

(6) The disclosure relates to elevated rack devices and more particularly pertains to a new elevated rack device for preparing food. The present invention discloses an elevated rack device that facilitates manipulation of a food item positioned upon a rack of the elevated rack device.

(2) Description of Related Art Including Information Disclosed Under 37 CFR 1.97 and 1.98

(7) The prior art relates to elevated rack devices, which may comprise racks attached to, or attachable to, bases by both of their ends, holding devices, such as spits, which are insertable into turkeys, chickens, and the like, as well as stands for deep frying. What is lacking in the prior art is

an elevated rack device comprising a base, to which a plurality of uprights is attached. A rack is attached to the plurality of uprights distally from the base and extends substantially colinearly with the base toward a second end of the base. In effect, only one end of the rack is attached to the base, allowing a bag to be positioned over the rack and a food item positioned on the rack, such as a turkey.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(8) An embodiment of the disclosure meets the needs presented above by generally comprising a base to which a plurality of uprights is attached. Each upright extends substantially perpendicularly from the base proximate to a first end of the base. A rack is attached to the plurality of uprights distal from the base and extends substantially colinearly with the base toward a second end of the base. A top of the rack is configured for positioning of a food item, such as a turkey, a chicken, a ham, or the like, with surfaces of the food item being substantially accessible to a user and the food item being slidable from the rack.

(9) There has thus been outlined, rather broadly, the more important features of the disclosure in order that the detailed description thereof that follows may be better understood, and in order that the present contribution to the art may be better appreciated. There are additional features of the disclosure that will be described hereinafter and which will form the subject matter of the claims appended hereto.

(10) The objects of the disclosure, along with the various features of novelty which characterize the disclosure, are pointed out with particularity in the claims annexed to and forming a part of this disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWING(S)

(1) The disclosure will be better understood and objects other than those set forth above will become apparent when consideration is given to the following detailed description thereof. Such description makes reference to the annexed drawings wherein:

(2) FIG. 1 is an isometric perspective view of an elevated rack device according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a top view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a front view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is an in-use view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is an isometric perspective view of an embodiment of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(7) With reference now to the drawings, and in particular to FIGS. 1 through 5 thereof, a new elevated rack device embodying the principles and concepts of an embodiment of the disclosure and generally designated by the reference numeral **10** will be described.

(8) As best illustrated in FIGS. 1 through 5, the elevated rack device **10** generally comprises a base **12**, to which a plurality of uprights **14** is attached. The base **12** comprises a pair of side members **16** and a crossmember **18**. The crossmember **18** is attached to and extends between the side members **16** proximate to a first end **20** of the base **12**. Each upright **14** extends substantially perpendicularly from the base **12** proximate to the first end **20** of the base **12**. The plurality of uprights **14** comprises an upright **14** that is attached to the crossmember **18** equally distant from the side members **16** and two uprights **14** that are attached singly to the side members **16** and positioned proximate to the crossmember **18** and between the crossmember **18** and the second end **24** of the base **12**.

(9) A rack **22** is attached to the plurality of uprights **14** distal from the base **12** and extends substantially colinearly with the base **12** toward a second end **24** of the base **12**. A top **26** of the

rack **22** is configured for positioning of a food item, such as turkey **60**, a chicken, a ham, or the like, as shown in FIG. **4**. Surfaces **30** of the food item **28** are substantially accessible to a user and the food item **28** is slidable from the rack **22**. The elevated rack device **10** facilitates initial prep work on the food item **28**, such as rinsing, drying, trimming, seasoning, stuffing, and bagging. With the food item **28** being a turkey **60**, the elevated rack device **10** allows for addition of fruit, vegetables, stuffing, and the like into an abdominal cavity of the turkey **60**. The elevated rack device **10** facilitates bagging of the food item **28** prior to cooking. Bagging is readily accomplished by positioning a bag (not shown) over the food item **28** and the rack **22**, sliding the bagged food item **28** off the rack **22** and into a roasting pan.

(10) The rack **22** comprises an annular rod **32** and a plurality of cross rods **34**. The annular rod **32** has opposed side segments **36** and opposed end segments **38**. Each cross rod **34** is attached to and extends between the opposed end segments **38** and is substantially parallel to the opposed side segments **36**. The opposed end segments **38** are arcuate so that the rack **22** is concave when viewed from the top **26** of the rack **22**, as shown in FIGS. **2** and **3**. The rack **22** being concave helps to retain the food item **28** upon the rack **22**.

(11) The elevated rack device **10** also may comprise a tray **40** and a plurality of scoops **42**, as shown in FIG. **5**. Each scoop **42** comprises a handle **44**, which is configured to be grasped in a hand of the user, positioning the user to scoop the items and to position them in the tray **40**.

(12) The tray **40** comprises a lower panel **46**, a rear panel **48**, and a pair of side panels **50**. The lower panel **46** is shaped substantially complementarily to the top **26** of the rack **22**. The lower panel **46** has a first edge **52** and a second edge **54**, with the latter being arcuate. The rear panel **48** is attached to and extends bidirectionally from the first edge **52** of the lower panel **46**. A lower section **58** of the rear panel **48** is positioned to abut a respective opposed end segment **38** of the annular rod **32**. Each side panel **50** is attached to the rear panel **48** and the lower panel **46**. The side panel **50** extends along a respective opposed side edge **56** of the lower panel **46** and tapers toward the second edge **54** of the lower panel **46**. The tray **40** is configured for positioning of items, such as, but not limited to, candies, ingredients, mirepoix, and the like. The rack **22** and the tray **40** are configured to be substantially covered with a bag, positioning a user to scoop or slide items from the tray **40** to transfer the items into a container, such as a bag.

(13) In use, a food item **28** is positioned on the top **26** of the rack **22**. The surfaces **30** of the food item **28** are substantially accessible to a user for initial prep work, such as rinsing, spices, drying, trimming, seasoning, stuffing. When preparing a turkey **60**, items such as fruit, vegetables, and stuffing can be inserted into the turkey **60**. The elevated rack device **10** allows a user to elect to bag the food item **28** prior to cooking. Bagging is readily accomplished by positioning a bag over the food item **28** and the rack **22**, sliding the bagged food item **28** off the rack **22** and into a roasting pan.

(14) With respect to the above description then, it is to be realized that the optimum dimensional relationships for the parts of an embodiment enabled by the disclosure, to include variations in size, materials, shape, form, function and manner of operation, assembly and use, are deemed readily apparent and obvious to one skilled in the art, and all equivalent relationships to those illustrated in the drawings and described in the specification are intended to be encompassed by an embodiment of the disclosure.

(15) Therefore, the foregoing is considered as illustrative only of the principles of the disclosure. Further, since numerous modifications and changes will readily occur to those skilled in the art, it is not desired to limit the disclosure to the exact construction and operation shown and described, and accordingly, all suitable modifications and equivalents may be resorted to, falling within the scope of the disclosure. In this patent document, the word “comprising” is used in its non-limiting sense to mean that items following the word are included, but items not specifically mentioned are not excluded. A reference to an element by the indefinite article “a” does not exclude the possibility

that more than one of the element is present, unless the context clearly requires that there be only one of the elements.

Claims

1. An elevated rack device, comprising: a base; a plurality of uprights, each upright being attached to and extending substantially perpendicularly from the base proximate to a first end of the base; and a rack attached to the plurality of uprights distal from the base and extending substantially colinearly with the base toward a second end of the base, wherein a top of the rack is configured for positioning of a food item, such that surfaces of the food item are substantially accessible to a user, and such that the food item is slidable from the rack; wherein the base comprises: a pair of side members; and a crossmember, the crossmember being attached to and extending between the side members proximate to the first end of the base; and wherein the plurality of uprights comprises: an upright attached to the crossmember equally distant from the side members; and two uprights attached singly to the side members and positioned proximate to the crossmember between the crossmember and the second end of the base.
2. An elevated rack device, comprising: a base; a plurality of uprights, each upright being attached to and extending substantially perpendicularly from the base proximate to a first end of the base; and a rack attached to the plurality of uprights distal from the base and extending substantially colinearly with the base toward a second end of the base, wherein a top of the rack is configured for positioning of a food item, such that surfaces of the food item are substantially accessible to a user, and such that the food item is slidable from the rack; and wherein the rack comprises: an annular rod having opposed side segments and opposed end segments; and a plurality of cross rods, each cross rod being attached to and extending between the opposed end segments, the cross rod being substantially parallel to the opposed side segments; and wherein the plurality of uprights comprises: an upright attached to the crossmember equally distant from the side members; and two uprights attached singly to the side members and positioned proximate to the crossmember between the crossmember and the second end of the base.
3. The elevated rack device of claim 2, wherein the opposed end segments are arcuate, such that the rack is concave when viewed from the top of the rack.
4. The elevated rack device of claim 3, further including a tray comprising: a lower panel shaped substantially complementarily to the top of the rack, the lower panel having a first edge and a second edge, the second edge being arcuate; a rear panel attached to and extending bidirectionally from the first edge of the lower panel, such that a lower section of the rear panel is positioned for abutting a respective opposed end segment of the annular rod; and a pair of side panels, each side panel being attached to the rear panel and the lower panel, the side panel extending along a respective opposed side edge of the lower panel and tapering toward the second edge of the lower panel, wherein the tray is configured for positioning of items and wherein the rack and the tray are configured for substantially covering with a bag, positioning a user for tilting the tray for transferring the items into a container.
5. The elevated rack device of claim 4, further including a plurality of scoops, each scoop comprising a handle, wherein the handle is configured for grasping in a hand of the user, positioning the user for selectively scooping the items and positioning them in the tray and for sliding the items into the container.
6. An elevated rack device comprising: a base, the base comprising a pair of side members and a crossmember, the crossmember being attached to and extending between the side members proximate to a first end of the base; a plurality of uprights, each upright being attached to and extending substantially perpendicularly from the base proximate to the first end of the base, the plurality of uprights comprising: an upright attached to the crossmember equally distant from the side members, and two uprights attached singly to the side members and positioned proximate to

the crossmember between the crossmember and a second end of the base; and a rack attached to the plurality of uprights distal from the base and extending substantially colinearly with the base toward the second end of the base, wherein a top of the rack is configured for positioning of a food item, such that surfaces of the food item are substantially accessible to a user, and such that the food item is slidable from the rack, the rack comprising: an annular rod having opposed side segments and opposed end segments, the opposed end segments being arcuate, such that the rack is concave when viewed from the top of the rack, and a plurality of cross rods, each cross rod being attached to and extending between the opposed end segments, the cross rod being substantially parallel to the opposed side segments.

7. The elevated rack device of claim 6, further including: a tray comprising: a lower panel shaped substantially complementarily to the top of the rack, the lower panel having a first edge and a second edge, the second edge being arcuate, a rear panel attached to and extending bidirectionally from the first edge of the lower panel, such that a lower section of the rear panel is positioned for abutting a respective opposed end segment of the annular rod, and a pair of side panels, each side panel being attached to the rear panel and the lower panel, the side panel extending along a respective opposed side edge of the lower panel and tapering toward a second edge of the lower panel, wherein the tray is configured for positioning of items and wherein the rack and the tray are configured for substantially covering with a bag, positioning a user for transferring the items into the container; and a plurality of scoops, each scoop comprising a handle, wherein the handle is configured for grasping in a hand of the user, positioning the user for selectively scooping the items and positioning them in the tray and for transferring the items from the tray to the container.
